

Itinerary — Elizabeth Wong

Southern Bahia Cacao Journey

29 September – 8 October 2026

Visiting: Elizabeth Wong — GO / Nucleus

Host: Gary Teh — TrueSight DAO / Agroverse

Base: Ilhéus · Itacaré, Bahia, Brazil

At a Glance

Arrive	Tuesday 29 September, 09:20 — Ilhéus (IOS Jorge Amado)
Depart	Thursday 8 October, 17:55 — Ilhéus (IOS Jorge Amado)
Confirmed visits	CIC (29 Sep) · Oscar's Farm (3 Oct)
Proposed	Warehouse · Santos Factory / Fábrica Santa Clara · Coopercabruca (30 Sep)
Region	Southern Bahia — Ilhéus · Itabuna · Itacaré
Timezone	Bahia (UTC−3) — all times local

Confirmed Visits

Date	Day	Site	Location
29 Sep	Tuesday	Centro de Inovação do Cacau (CIC)	UESC campus, Ilhéus
3 Oct	Saturday	Oscar's Farm	Southern Bahia

Proposed Visits — Wednesday 30 September

Site	What	Location
DAO / Black King Warehouse	Cacao stock consolidation and export staging	Ilhéus
Santos Factory — Fábrica Santa Clara	Bean-to-bar conversion; roasting and moulding	Ilhéus area
Coopercabruca	Producer cooperative — quick visit with Orlantides Santos Pereira	Itabuna

Flights

Outbound — Hong Kong to Ilhéus (31h 35m)

Date	Depart	Flight	Arrive
28 Sep	12:45 — HKG T1	Cathay Pacific CX884	10:45 — LAX (B)
28 Sep	13:55 — LAX T2	LATAM LA8087	29 Sep 05:30 — GRU (T3)
29 Sep	07:20 — GRU T2	LATAM LA3254	29 Sep 09:20 — IOS Ilhéus

Transfers: Los Angeles 3h 10m (collect and re-check baggage, terminal change); São Paulo 1h 50m (short transfer).

Return — Ilhéus to Hong Kong (38h)

Date	Depart	Flight	Arrive
8 Oct	17:55 — IOS	LATAM LA4603	8 Oct 20:10 — GRU (T2)
8 Oct	23:15 — GRU T3	LATAM LA8086	9 Oct 07:40 — LAX (B)
9 Oct	12:25 — LAX (B)	Cathay Pacific CX885	10 Oct 18:55 — HKG T1

Day by Day

Date	Day	Plan
28 Sep	Mon	Depart Hong Kong. In transit (HKG → LAX → GRU).
29 Sep	Tue	Arrive Ilhéus 09:20. Visit CIC (Cacao Innovation Center). Overnight in Ilhéus.
30 Sep	Wed	Ilhéus / Itabuna circuit — DAO warehouse, Santos Factory (Fábrica Santa Clara), Coopercabruca (quick visit). Transfer toward Itacaré.
1 Oct	Thu	Itacaré — farm immersion (proposed: Fazenda Clara, Vivi's "Jesus do Deus"). Evening: forró or capoeira.
2 Oct	Fri	Itacaré — flexible day, positioning toward Oscar's region. Evening: LahSelva's "Wild Forró".
3 Oct	Sat	Oscar's Farm — full-day visit: harvest, fermentation, sun-drying.

Date	Day	Plan
4 Oct	Sun	Rest and reflection. Optional: Vipassana meditation (11:00), family constellation (17:00).
5 Oct	Mon	Cultural day in and around Itacaré. Evening: Casa Maré forró (18:00).
6 Oct	Tue	Flex day — follow-ups and media capture. Evening: capoeira (18:00).
7 Oct	Wed	Transfer to Ilhéus. Final logistics and media.
8 Oct	Thu	Final visits in Ilhéus. Depart 17:55 for Hong Kong.

The two confirmed visits are CIC (29 Sep) and Oscar's Farm (3 Oct). The 30 Sep circuit and the remaining days are proposed and to be confirmed.

Where You Will Go

Centro de Inovação do Cacau (CIC) — Ilhéus

The cacao science and quality center for southern Bahia, on the UESC university campus (Rodovia Jorge Amado, km 16, Ilhéus). This is where Bahia cacao is analysed and graded — fermentation quality, physical-chemical testing and traceability. The lab reports issued here underpin the quality story behind our fine cacao.

Santos Factory — Fábrica Santa Clara — Ilhéus area

The bean-to-bar conversion partner. Here cacao is roasted, refined and moulded into finished chocolate — the step that turns our beans into bars. Santos works with us through Fatima Toledo, and this is the facility at the center of our current 40 kg Oscar cacao processing conversation.

DAO / Black King Warehouse — Ilhéus

The consolidation point for cacao stock and export staging. Beans from partner farms are gathered, graded and prepared here before freight — the physical hub of the Brazil export lane.

Coopercabruca — Itabuna

A producer cooperative (Cooperativa dos Cacaucultores do Sul da Bahia) whose member farms supply cabruca cacao. We meet Orlantides Santos Pereira, the cooperative's president. It holds the IE and NF-e credentials behind our export paperwork.

Oscar's Farm — southern Bahia

A working cabruca cacao farm — cacao grown in the shade of native Atlantic Forest trees. Meet Oscar (Oscar Martins da Silva Miranda) and follow the bean from harvest through fermentation and sun-drying. Oscar is one of the growers behind our current export.

Itacaré

Coastal base for the second half of the visit — a town on the cacao coast, surrounded by rivers, rainforest and cacao farms, with a lively calendar of forró, capoeira and yoga. A natural place to rest between farm days.

Practical Notes

- Timezone: Bahia, Brazil (UTC−3). All times above are local.
- Ilhéus (IOS) to Itacaré: approx. 70 km, 1h 20m to 2h by car (BA-001 coastal road).
- Ilhéus to Itabuna: approx. 25 km — CIC, the warehouse, Santos factory and Coopercabruca sit within one short drive of each other.
- Ground transport and driver: to be arranged by your host.
- Dress: light clothing, hat and closed shoes for farm days; mornings can be wet.
- Media: photos and video are welcome at all sites.